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(e) Magic and science

Frazer in his book 'The Golden Bough (1928)' defined magic as the activity towards a specific aim to compel supernatural.

Science is structured study of natural processes through observations and facts.

Concepts of magic

Similarities

- 1) Both imply that there are certain causative factors of various processes.
- 2) Both follow a set of principles.
- 3) Both rely on human confidence on arriving on results.

* Malinowski in his book Magic, Science and Religion (1925) said that science is sacred and magic is half profane.

→ So you also need to show the concept

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Differences

Magic

- 1) It is caused by supernatural powers
- 2) Based on hope
- 3) Based on absolutes
- 4) Failure in magic is due to failure in processes followed
- 5) It is ~~not~~ related to uncertainty, ambiguity

Science

- 1) Based on real world & natural processes.
- 2) Based on evidence, facts and figures.
- 3) Based on probability
- 4) Failure in science is due to wrong empirical methods employed.
- 5) It is a matter of fact.

Hence, both magic and science are a characteristics of societies. However magic is more prominent in simple societies while science being more prominent in modern societies

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187 Define what is magic.

You need to clearly show